

Christiaan Verhoef

Innovation Lab Lead | Ecosystem Builder | ZZP Interim

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SUMMARY

Innovation lab builder and ecosystem architect. I stand up multi-person innovation teams inside institutional contexts, connect them to external partner networks, and build the structures that make them keep running after the mandate ends. Done this at Windesheim University (Spark! Living Lab, 2020–present), at Aeres Hogeschool (10-startup innovation hub, 2021–22), and in parallel as co-founder of Tonomy Foundation, a pan-European identity platform built with a distributed team from the ground up. 10+ years of this. Dutch native, English near-native. Available ZZP, Leiden commutable from Baarn.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Innovation Lab Leadership	Ecosystem Architecture	Partnership Development	Grant Facilitation (EUR 2M+)	Portfolio Management
Multi-stakeholder Facilitation	Prince2 / ITIL	Agile / Scrum (15+ yrs)	Dutch native / English near-native	ZZP / Interim

WORK EXPERIENCE

Windesheim University of Applied Sciences

Jan 2020 -- Present

Project Manager -- Innovation Labs | Zwolle, Netherlands

- **Spark! Living Lab:** Built from zero. Beer Game blockchain simulation platform, external partners onboarded, multi-year applied research programme running. Comparable in structure to an 8-person multidisciplinary tech hub.
- **Value Chain Hackers:** AI-powered compliance tooling for enterprise supply chain audits (CSRD, EUDR, CSDDD). Principal investigator, programme manager, and technical lead. Cross-sector consortium: corporates, NGOs, research institutes. Presented to executive teams at partner organisations.
- Self-hosted AI infrastructure (Flowise, n8n, Supabase, Docker/Linux) for university researchers. Design, deploy, maintain.
- Co-authored grant proposals; approximately EUR 2M in innovation funding facilitated.

Aeres Hogeschool

2021 -- 2022

Lab Manager -- Regional Innovation Hub | Dronten, Netherlands

- Built a new innovation hub from zero in an institution with no prior innovation infrastructure. Merged 8 separate courses into one sprint-based innovation track in under 2 months. Recruited student and industry participants, structured the programme, coached teams.
- Incubated 10 student projects through the innovation programme. Two became operating companies.
- Veles Farming: identified a student project worth backing, became seed investor and mentor, guided to operating agri-tech company in Slovakia (EUR 2M funding).
- Demonstrated: ecosystem building, team leadership, portfolio oversight, external partner engagement -- from a standing start in an unfamiliar sector.

Tonomy Foundation

2021 -- Present

Co-Founder | Amsterdam and Remote

- Built open-source identity platform from zero. Defined technical architecture, led partner development and ecosystem strategy across Netherlands, UK, and Germany. Sprint cycles with distributed European team.
- Product reached W3C Credentials Community Group recognition stage. Team contributed to implementation of W3C CCG Conditional Proof standard in the DIF did-jwt library.
- Presented at international blockchain/identity forums. Built external partnerships and funding pipelines from scratch.

Social Chicken / 2bSMART

2016 -- 2022

Freelance Innovation Consultant | Amsterdam / Benelux

- Enterprise blockchain and AI training to corporate and government clients across Benelux. Complex technical concepts to non-technical executive audiences.
- Technical due diligence for pre-seed startup; investment recommendation; 4x exit achieved.

Field Service Engineer -- BI Deployments | Kristiansand, Norway

- Solo deployment engineer at BP and Statoil across four countries (Jordan, Oman, Houston, Azerbaijan). Safety-critical environments. No internet access, no support line. Full procedure compliance plus independent problem-solving when the procedure ran out.
- Azerbaijan: read full BP contract, identified specific clauses, confronted GeoServices division manager over withheld data. Resolved in one day. No formal authority.
- This combination -- strict process adherence in regulated environments, plus initiative when the manual doesn't cover it -- is the operating mode I bring to regulated corporate innovation contexts.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor Business IT & Management -- Hogeschool van Amsterdam

2010--2014

Grade: 8.7/10. Thesis: simulation-based learning for complex system operators (KONGSBERG). Minor: E-discovery and digital forensics.

Certifications: Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I), PSPO I, Prince2, ITIL, Oracle 11g, Offshore Survival/HUET

Languages: Dutch (native), English (near-native), German (conversational)

Availability: ZZP/Interim | Leiden commutable from Baarn (approx. 60 min by train) | Per direct